

THE ART DIGEST

Vol. 25, No. 14

The News Magazine of Art

April 15, 1951



VOL. XIII, No. 7

APRIL, 1951

MAURICE SIEVAN is an Expressionistic interpreter of Provincetown, Long Island and Suburbia in general. His landscapes are invested with strange, drab lights. *Provincetown Seascape* avoids the banality implicit in its title by a strange atmospheric modulation of sunlight. Tree forms are evidently more or less spontaneous tracers which inject strategic accents, while varied shades of gray provide an anchor. *Portrait of a Composer* uses nervous blues and yellows sunk into surrounding somber tones. These paintings can be seen at the Salpeter Gallery through the latter half of April and into May. Reproduction on p. 32.

Sievan's New York Environs

The visual impact of the moment is achieved by Maurice Sievan in a series of recent oils most of them landscapes of New York environs.

He creates an almost watercolor-like spontaneity by using a quick and flowing brush stroke, yet leaving portions of his canvas blank. In *At Sag Harbor* sky and water are a dull and opaque grey, while the land is merely suggested by roughly sketched plants.

Somewhat different is *Suburban Retreat* in which romantic undertones of a summer day exist. *Portrait of a Composer* and a landscape, *Provincetown Harbor*, have bright and dissonant colors laid more heavily on the canvas.

In all, freedom of execution, romantic mood or dissonant color have sound academic composition as their common ground. (Salpeter, to May 5.)—M. C.

Mary Cole

NEW YORK HERALD TRIBUNE,
FRIDAY, APRIL 20, 1951

A group of landscapes (with an occasional informal portrait study included) provide a spirited show at the Harry Salpeter gallery. Maurice Sievan, the artist whose works are shown, feels intensely the spirit of the open country, whose space, form and atmosphere he interprets with brushwork sometimes steady, at other times rendered in swirling ribbons of pigment. This is at best an art of exhilarating impressionism, muted and tasteful in color harmony, at its least effective a brush-flicking which becomes a mannerism more than painting of vital and controlled definition. C. B.

Carlyle Barron

Volume 50 Number 2 April 1951

P. 59

ART NEWS FOUNDED 1902

Reg. U.S. Pat. Off. Copyright 1951 The Art Foundation, Inc.

Maurice Sievan [Salpeter; April 16-May 5] of Flushing, head of the adult art education program at Queens College, will open his fifth show. These mild, unassuming land- and seascapes gradually insinuate their atmospheric quality. Sievan's experienced and sensitive eye enables him to create deep vistas with economy, and to activate the space with whirling lines in which air and light meet. \$100-\$700. P.B.R.

Page 59



Street Scene in Flushing: MAURICE SIEVAN
On View at the Harry Salpeter Gallery, N. Y. C.

purple pencil is ms. of Lee Stevan